2017, Prime Minister Abe pushed ahead with the TPP 11, renamed the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership, with the remaining eleven nations. Coming into effect at the end of 2018, the reborn pact links Japan initially with Australia, New Zealand, Singapore, and Vietnam in the Asia-Pacific (along with Mexico and Canada), though other nations in Asia, including South Korea, Indonesia, Taiwan, and Thailand, have expressed interest in exploring negotiations to join the group.[19] For Tokyo, the TPP still remains the germ of a larger community of interests based on enhanced trade and investment, as well as adoption of common regulatory schemes, all designed to blunt China's dominant trade position in the region.

China has sought over the last decade to catch up with Japan on the trade front, signing its own FTA with ASEAN in 2010 and updating it in 2015, with the goal of reaching two-way trade totaling $1 trillion and investment of $150 billion by 2020. More significantly, China has adopted a 2011 ASEAN initiative, the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP), which would link the ten ASEAN nations with their six dialogue partners: China, Japan, South Korea, India, Australia, and New Zealand. Accounting for nearly 40 percent of global output and linking close to 3.5 billion people, the RCEP increasingly has come to be seen as China's alternative to TPP. While Japan and Australia in particular have sought to slow final agreement over RCEP, Beijing has been given a huge boost by the Trump administration's withdrawal from the TPP and the widespread impression that China is now the global economic leader. Tokyo is finding little success in combating such opinion yet continues to try to offer alternatives to China-dominated economic initiatives. One such approach is to remain engaged in RCEP negotiations, and another is to have the ADB cofund certain projects with the AIIB. This type of cooperative competition between Japan and China may become the norm in regional economic relations, even as each seeks to maximize its influence both in institutions and with Asian states.